

OpenVAS: The Popular Vulnerability Assessment Tool

Here's a comprehensive guide to how you can use OpenVAS to fix potential security issues before they crop up.

In an era where organisations gravitate towards new technologies, finding and fixing security weaknesses is mandatory. The process of identifying potential problems before these can be exploited by attackers is known as vulnerability analysis.

One of the most common open source tools used for this is OpenVAS (Open Vulnerability Assessment System), which is part of the Greenbone Vulnerability Management (GVM) framework. Let's see how we can use this tool effectively.

Installing and accessing OpenVAS

First, we must have Docker on our system. If it's not already installed, let's open a terminal and run the necessary commands to set it up.

```
$ sudo apt install docker.io
```

We can now use a single command to download the OpenVAS image and start it as a container.

```
$ sudo docker run -d -p 443:443 --name openvas mikesplain/openvas
```

Open a browser window and type <https://127.0.0.1> for the login page (as shown in Figure 1). Enter the username

as *admin* and password also as *admin*. The interface looks like what's shown in Figure 1. We can change the username and password later.

After logging in, the interface looks like what is shown in Figure 2.

Performing a vulnerability scan

To perform a vulnerability scan on a target system to identify potential

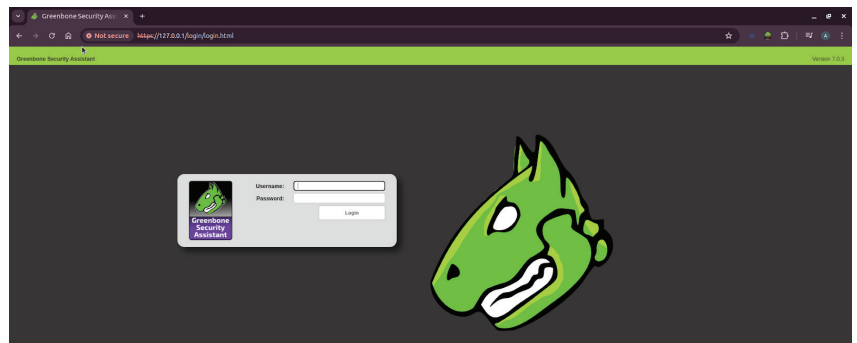


Figure 1: Login page

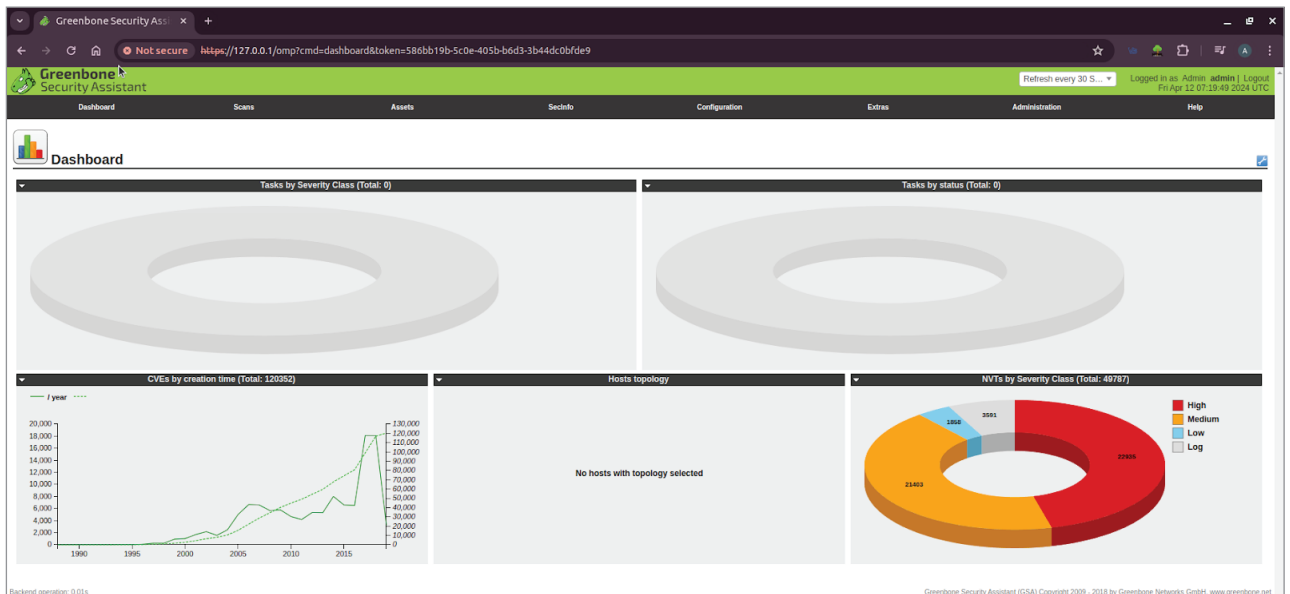


Figure 2: Initial interface